

Spec Examples – Student:

- **Good (~₹35k):** Core i3 (13th Gen) or Ryzen 3; 8 GB RAM; 256 GB SSD; integrated graphics; 15.6" FHD.
- **Better (~₹50k):** Core i5 (U-series) or Ryzen 5; 16 GB RAM; 512 GB SSD; integrated graphics; 14" FHD IPS.
- **Best (~₹60k):** Core i7 (P-series) / Ryzen 7, or Apple M1; 16 GB RAM; 512 GB SSD; 14–15" FHD (or 2K) display.

Hybrid Office / Road Warrior (₹60k–₹80k)

Professionals who work on the move need portability, endurance, and connectivity. Look for a lightweight ultrabook (~1.3–1.5 kg) with solid build quality. 8–10 hours of real-world battery life is a good target – enough for a full workday or long flight. Efficient processors (Intel 13th Gen U/P-series, AMD Ryzen 7 U-series) provide a balance of performance and battery. Aim for 16 GB RAM for smooth multitasking (spreadsheets, video calls, many browser tabs) and at least a 512 GB SSD for storage.



Durability matters: a metal chassis or MIL-STD tested model can better withstand travel wear and tear. Business-class laptops (ThinkPad, Latitude, etc.) often have excellent keyboards.

Good connectivity is a must. Ensure it has multiple USB ports and an HDMI or at least a USB-C with DisplayPort for plugging into projectors/monitors. Thunderbolt 4/USB4 support is a bonus if you use docks or need dual-monitors from one port. Most new laptops have Wi-Fi 6/6E, which is sufficient.

- **Spend on:** Battery capacity and build quality. It's worth a slightly lower-tier CPU if it comes with a bigger battery or sturdier body. Also invest in a comfortable display (matte, 300+ nits brightness for outdoor use) and 16 GB RAM for longevity.
- **Save on:** High-end graphics and 4K screens. Integrated graphics will handle office work and video calls. A Full HD or 1200p screen is usually sharp enough at 13–14" and draws less power than a 4K panel.

Spec Examples – Professional:

- **Good (~₹60k):** Core i5-1340P; 16 GB RAM; 512 GB SSD; 14" FHD IPS; ~10 hr battery.
- **Better (~₹70k):** Ryzen 77840U; 16 GB RAM; 1 TB SSD; 14" 2.2K IPS; Thunderbolt/USB4.
- **Best (~₹80k):** Core i7-1360P; 16–32 GB RAM; 1 TB SSD; 13.5" 3:2 high-res display; Thunderbolt 4.

Creator (₹80k–₹1.2 L+)

Content creators (video editors, designers, 3D artists) need powerful CPUs, discrete GPUs, and ample memory. You'll want an Intel Core H-series or AMD Ryzen H-series processor (or Apple M2/M3 Pro/Max) plus a dedicated GPU like an NVIDIA RTX 4060/4070 or better for smooth rendering and timeline scrubbing. Such hardware can handle 4K video editing and complex effects, but note it tends to run hot and consume battery – many creator laptops only get ~5–6 hours on light use, so expect to be plugged in for long editing sessions.

A high-quality, color-accurate display is important. Look for at least a 15-inch high-resolution panel (1080p is entry-level, QHD or 4K is better) with a wide color gamut (100% sRGB or higher). Some creator-focused laptops include mini-LED or OLED screens with full DCI-P3 color gamut and pro ports like HDMI 2.1 and SD card readers for media transfer.

RAM and storage: 16 GB is the minimum (32 GB recommended for heavy multitasking), and at least a 1 TB SSD is advised since project files are large (external SSDs can supplement if needed).

- **Spend on:** CPU/GPU power and sufficient RAM. These directly impact how fast you can render, export, or run complex filters. Also invest in a good display (if you can't use an external calibrated monitor, the laptop's own screen should be up to the task).
- **Save on:** Ultraportability and battery. A thicker laptop with better cooling is fine – it will sustain performance longer. And since intensive work is done plugged in, a slightly smaller battery is acceptable if it lets you afford a better GPU or screen.

